NCCA ENTERTAINMENT · CAST SUGGESTIONS

THE CAREGIVER'S SECRET

Wish list for a Lifetime / LMN original

> *This is a wish list, not an offer sheet. No actor, agent or representative has been approached. Availability, interest, pricing and fit are unverified, and nothing here is a statement about anyone's involvement.*

ROLE	PROFILE	SUGGESTIONS	WHY THEY ARE A FIT
DANA REYES	Lead. 34, LPN, single mother. The audience lives in her notebook. Grounded, watchful, funny when scared.	Melissa Barrera · Diane Guerrero · Camila Mendes	Needs credibility as a working nurse and a mother, plus the physical restraint to play most scenes with a camera pointed at her and no one to confide in.
ELEANOR WHITFIELD	72, former senator and whistleblower. Mostly nonverbal. Plays almost entirely with eyes, a left hand and one thumb.	Phylicia Rashad · Sissy Spacek · Lorraine Toussaint	The role is a legacy-actress gift: authority without speech. Prior stage or screen gravitas is more important than name value alone.
PRISCILLA WHITFIELD-VANCE	Mid 40s to early 50s, foundation chair, Eleanor's daughter. Warm, exact, wounded. Never a cartoon.	Elizabeth Reaser · Tiffani Thiessen · Kelly Rutherford	Must be able to be tender and terrifying inside one tea scene. The cardigan-and-cashmere threat.
DR. ADRIAN VANCE	50s, Priscilla's husband and Eleanor's physician. Weak, not evil. Ends by choosing.	Scott Foley · Jason Priestley · Tim Daly	Needs likeable-coward energy and an audience that hopes he will stand up before he does.
MARGOT BELL	Mid 50s, Whitfield housekeeper of eleven years. Loyalty as a trap.	Wendy Raquel Robinson · Kimberly Elise · Judy Reyes	Her turn at pre-dawn is the movie's moral hinge. Casting should lean toward an actress known for restraint.
ROSA REYES	Early 60s, Dana's mother. Former Buckhead household manager. Sees leverage in kindness.	Rosie Perez · Justina Machado · Angélica Aragón	Her scenes are short and each has a fact in it. Needs warmth with a hard edge.
KEZIA ADAMS	Speech-language pathologist, 40s to 50s. Careful, procedural, quietly fearless.	Sheryl Lee Ralph · Anika Noni Rose · Tonya Pinkins	The scene that proves Eleanor's response is purposeful lives on her face and her notes.
DET. LENA ORTIZ	40s, APD Financial Crimes. Stays outside the house until the end.	Roselyn Sánchez · Aimee Garcia · Camille Guaty	Procedural clarity, no speeches. Two driveway calls and a hospital hallway.
THERESA HOLLIS	30s to 40s, prior caregiver. Warns Dana from outside the gate. Lead of the companion series.	Yvonne Orji · Sufe Bradshaw · Gabrielle Dennis	Needs to carry a vertical series alone and still land a two-minute gate call in the feature.
WALTER and RAY	Walter: 60s, board member, believes Priscilla. Ray: 50s, gate guard, ex-police energy, follows the wrong person then the right one.	Archetype search through the Atlanta character-actor pool. No names suggested.	Both are lean supporting parts. Ray is planted early so his later choice at the bedroom door lands.
LUCA REYES	8 years old. Serious, small, precise. Block letters on a cardboard house.	Open casting	Atlanta child-actor search. Bilingual helpful, not required. A child who can sit still on a phone screen.

PACKAGING NOTES

- **Anchor first.** The most leverage comes from two names: Dana and Eleanor. Chase them in that order, and let them pull in the rest of the cast.
- **Eleanor is the prestige role.** A legacy actress with extreme physical range is the single biggest differentiator against a standard Lifetime thriller.
- **Keep the child local.** Luca is the only role where an open Atlanta search is both cheaper and better.
- **Atlanta-friendly ensemble.** Margot, Ortiz, Walter, Ray, Lowry and the supports can come from the regional pool, which helps the schedule.

- **Companion series.** Theresa leads the vertical series and appears in two short feature scenes. Her deal should include the extension days up front.